

MA323 : Lab 8 Report

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Q1

We know that we can reduce the sample variance by using the control variate method. The required estimator is :

$$e^U + c(U - \mathbb{E}[U])$$

where

$$c = -\frac{Cov(e^U, U)}{Var(U)}$$

as this value of c minimises the variance the most.

We can do the necessary computations and obtain this as our final estimator :

$$e^U - 6(3 - e)(U - 0.5)$$

Results

The code was ran and following results were obtained :

M	I_M	Var	$\hat{I}_M$	$\widehat{Var}$	%Imp	$\tilde{I}_M$	$\widetilde{Var}$	%Imp
10	1.56297	0.252897	1.71926	0.005398	97.866	1.72994	0.003525	98.606
100	1.73603	0.254168	1.72212	0.004182	98.355	1.72833	0.003827	98.494
1000	1.7215	0.228691	1.71687	0.00402	98.242	1.72011	0.003895	98.297
10000	1.71786	0.240794	1.71902	0.003936	98.365	1.71755	0.003881	98.388
100000	1.7179	0.242763	1.71833	0.003911	98.389	1.71823	0.003944	98.375

We can observe that both the methods can easily get upto 98% reduction in variance when compared to the crude technique. The control variate method also works slightly better than the antithetic variables method when less number of estimators ($M = 10, 100$) are used.

Q2

For the conditioning technique, our estimator will be $\mathbb{E}[I_{(X>1)}|Y]$ and we know that $\mathbb{E}[I_{(X>1)}|Y = y] = 1 - \Phi(\frac{1-y}{2})$ since $X \sim N(y, 4)$

I don't know what control variable to take for the control variate technique. I tried taking X, Y but the c^* calculation doesn't look worth it. It's like cutting your arm in order to treat a fungal infection on your pinkie.

For the antithetic technique:

$$I_M = \frac{1}{M} \sum_{i=1}^{M/2} 1 - \frac{1}{2} [\Phi(\frac{1 + \ln(U_i)}{2}) + \Phi(\frac{1 + \ln(1 - U_i)}{2})]$$

Results

$\hat{I}_M$ denotes antithetic (using conditional variables) method and $\tilde{I}_M$ denotes conditional method

M	I_M	Var	$\hat{I}_M$	$\widehat{Var}$	%Imp	$\tilde{I}_M$	$\widetilde{Var}$	%Imp
10	0.2	0.177778	0.51552	0.041261	76.791	0.49834	0.02869	83.862
100	0.48	0.252121	0.48157	0.021341	91.535	0.49392	0.027611	89.049
1000	0.482	0.249926	0.48908	0.025813	89.672	0.48219	0.025807	89.674
10000	0.493	0.249976	0.48889	0.026009	89.595	0.49074	0.027101	89.159
100000	0.48946	0.249891	0.48992	0.026529	89.384	0.48914	0.026467	89.409

Both methods are at par I would say.

Q3

It's pretty obvious that the discrete values of N will be used as the stratas for this problem. The following results were obtained :

M	I_M	Var	$\hat{I}_M$	$\widehat{Var}$	99% CI
100	0.38	0.23798	0.459999	0.001589	(0.35714, 0.562858)
10000	0.3663	0.232148	0.364099	0.000016	(0.353633, 0.374566)

The confidence interval given by the crude method was a super set of $[0, 1]$ so it didn't make sense to include it in the results. The variance reduction due to this method is drastic.